Checkpoint 2 Writeup

Our proposition is whether or not we are winning the fight against climate change as the world economy continues to grow. The visualizations either show that as the economy grows, carbon emissions are not growing at the same rate, or that emissions are still growing at a rapid rate.

The first visual uses the deceptive technique of truncating the y-axis to make the change in the data look bigger, and also displays a large percentage showing the change in values even though the actual difference of the values isn't much. Also, the chart shows emissions per dollar of GDP, but fails to give information about how much GDP is growing.

The second visual uses the deceptive technique of comparing the growth in emissions per person to GDP per capita, even though the higher growth in GDP does not necessarily mean the emission rates are under control. They also only show values when compared to the value from 1990, so don't give us a sense of how high emissions truly are.

The third visual truncates the y-axis to make the increase in values seem larger, uses the color red to help convey a feeling of a worsening climate crisis, and uses an annotation to emphasize the percent change and also the fact that there seems to be no end in sight

The fourth visual uses the color red for the upper line to try to convey a sense of danger, and uses an annotation to highlight how that line has almost doubled in value over time. The visual is also deceiving in that it does not highlight what the rate of industrialization is for third world countries.

We are leaning towards the two visualizations which oppose the idea that we are beating climate change. This is because these visualizations clearly show how emissions are still continuing to increase at a rapid pace. While the visuals supporting the idea might show that economic growth is moving faster than emissions, they still fail to strongly convey the idea that we are beating climate change.